

Award
FINRA Dispute Resolution Services

In the Matter of the Arbitration Between:

Claimant
Bruce Zipper

Case Number: 25-01128

vs.

Respondent
Charles Schwab & Co., Inc.

Hearing Site: Boca Raton, Florida

Awards are rendered by independent arbitrators who are chosen by the parties to issue final, binding decisions. FINRA makes available an arbitration forum—pursuant to rules approved by the SEC—but has no part in deciding the award.

Nature of the Dispute: Customer vs. Member

This matter proceeded pursuant to Rule 12800 of the Code of Arbitration Procedure (“Code”). The customer did not request a hearing.

REPRESENTATION OF PARTIES

Claimant Bruce Zipper (“Claimant”) appeared pro se.

For Respondent Charles Schwab & Co., Inc. (“Respondent”): Taylor Bandy, Esq. and Sara Soto, Esq., Bressler Amery & Ross, P.C., Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

CASE INFORMATION

Statement of Claim filed on or about: June 3, 2025.
Claimant signed the Submission Agreement: June 3, 2025.

Statement of Answer filed on or about: August 22, 2025.
Respondent signed the Submission Agreement: August 21, 2025.

CASE SUMMARY

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant alleged that he was a victim of “IP Spoofing.” Claimant further alleged that shares of a stock, MariMed, were purchased on margin, which he did not authorize, and Respondent should not have executed the orders entered in Claimant’s account, and, instead, should have called Claimant to discuss the transactions and recommended that he not place them.

Unless specifically admitted in the Statement of Answer, Respondent denied the allegations made in the Statement of Claim and asserted various affirmative defenses.

RELIEF REQUESTED

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant requested compensatory damages in the amount of \$1,000.00; punitive damages in the amount of \$3,500.00; costs in the amount of \$100.00; and interest in the amount of \$50.00.

In the Statement of Answer, Respondent requested that the Arbitrator deny Claimant's claims in their entirety and assess of all forum and hearing fees against Claimant.

OTHER ISSUES CONSIDERED AND DECIDED

The Arbitrator acknowledges having read the pleadings and other materials filed by the parties.

AWARD

After considering the pleadings, the Arbitrator has decided and determined in full and final resolution of the issues submitted for determination as follows:

1. Claimant's claims are denied in their entirety.
2. FINRA Dispute Resolution Services shall retain the \$175.00 filing fee that Claimant deposited previously.
3. Any and all claims for relief not specifically addressed herein, including any requests for punitive damages, treble damages, and attorneys' fees, are denied.

FEES

Pursuant to the Code:

1. Respondent has paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$165.00 Member Surcharge previously invoiced.

All balances are payable to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services and are due upon receipt.

ARBITRATOR

Barry David Thorpe

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Sole Public Arbitrator

I, the undersigned Arbitrator, do hereby affirm that I am the individual described herein and who executed this instrument, which is my award.

Arbitrator's Signature

Barry David Thorpe

Barry David Thorpe
Sole Public Arbitrator

12/23/2025

Signature Date

Awards are rendered by independent arbitrators who are chosen by the parties to issue final, binding decisions. FINRA makes available an arbitration forum—pursuant to rules approved by the SEC—but has no part in deciding the award.

December 23, 2025

Date of Service (For FINRA Dispute Resolution Services use only)